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General Comment

Generative AI is an algorithm capable of generating superficially convincing text and images, but only superficially. It presents serious dangers, as most of the jobs people want it to do, it is inherently incapable of, but can often produce something that looks convincing until you try to use it. This can have disastrous results, such as AI generated mushroom guides leading to poisoning. This problem is built into the generative AI concept itself, because it is only a statistical analysis of existing creations.

To reach even this flawed and dangerous state, AI companies have had to steal vast amounts of copyrighted material. They have said openly, many times, that large scale generative AI depends entirely on this theft. And it is theft. Again, generative AI is nothing but a copying and remixing machine. It does not use the works it is trained on to learn how to create, it simply copies by statistical model. To the extent it ever succeeds, it is because it stole content from the original creator.

Combining these traits, the thing generative AI is best at is being used for dubiously legal or directly illegal scams, where quality is not necessarily, only vast amounts of material that seems convincing at a glance. Then we add in another major problem - by depending on large amounts of stolen data, generative AI engines contain legally sensitive information such as legal documents and medical records, which the con artists already drawn to these tools are motivated to misuse.

In conclusion, AI certainly needs a governmental plan in place, but the policy changes needed are more limits on what generative AI can be trained from and used for. Subsidizing AI companies to do more of what they are doing now will only make these existing problems worse.